

C2-03 Professional Power BI Modeling - Start Here

Begin here before PBM-A1

WHY THIS MODULE EXISTS

A BI report can be visually excellent and still be structurally wrong. This module teaches the model layer that makes filters, measures and reports trustworthy: explicit grain, one-side key quality, star schemas, deliberate relationships, date roles, validation and measured performance.

EXACT ROUTE

PBM-A1 book -> matching practice sheet + Power BI Desktop build -> save genuine model evidence + validation -> explain-back -> protected review -> changed retry. Repeat through PBM-A10. Then integrated Mini-Lab -> Gate A. Gate B/C stay protected.

LIVE TOOL RULE

The workbook can prove your design reasoning, but relationship/filter/model execution must be demonstrated in Power BI Desktop where the lesson requires it. Do not mark Desktop-dependent mastery from screenshots in the book alone.

C2-03 prerequisites and tools

New modeling concepts are still taught from zero

YOU SHOULD ALREADY KNOW

How to open/import data in Power BI, build a simple visual, identify a table/column and explain basic row grain. C2-00 validation language is helpful.

YOU NEED

Power BI Desktop for hands-on mastery; supplied CSV/XLSX practice assets; optional spreadsheet app for QA workbook. No Power BI Service/Fabric tenant is required.

RECOVERY

If Desktop cannot run, record ENVIRONMENT BLOCKED. Continue conceptual study if useful, but do not convert a missing runtime into false mastery. If basic Power BI navigation is weak, repair Course 1 only for that skill.

C2-03 mastery / Gate contract

No diagram-only mastery and no percentage gaming

LESSON PASS

Model/design attempt + Desktop evidence where required + one-side key/unmatched/grain controls + filter/total validation + explain-back + changed retry. A relationship line appearing in Model view is not enough.

GATE A

Fresh integrated semantic-model case with mixed grains, relationships, date roles, quality and validation.

B/C RETEST

Fresh domains/data. A critical grain/key/cardinality/filter/reconciliation defect blocks pass. Repair never auto-opens the next Gate.